



LESSON PLAN

MONDAY 14.09.2026 · TWO AND A HALF SESSIONS · LEVEL A2

THE DAY

11.00 – 11.45	Revision: your hero + Past Simple	45 min
11.45 – 12.00	Break	15 min
12.00 – 13.35	Preparing the presentation	95 min
13.35 – 14.05	Lunch	30 min
14.05 – 15.40	Plenary · presentations · awards	95 min

BY THE END OF THE DAY STUDENTS CAN

- recall the life of Elizabeth I and re-tell it in the Past Simple
- listen to a three-minute A2 talk and take the facts out of it
- build their own criteria for **WHAT MAKES A GREAT PERSON** and defend them
- find evidence for and against Elizabeth's greatness in what she actually did
- give a ten-minute team presentation in English with a clear line of argument
- judge other teams against the same criteria and vote for the award winners

ON THE TABLE BEFORE YOU START

SHEET VI	Elizabeth I – reading, exercises, board call-backs	1 per student
SHEET XII	Past Simple on Elizabeth I	1 per student
LISTENING SHEET	“The Queen Who Said No” – worksheet	1 per student
AUDIO SCRIPT	read aloud by the teacher – keys on the back	teacher only
GREAT PERSON SHEET	criteria, evidence grid, the greatness test	1 per student
PRESENTATION KIT	roles, timing plan, sentence frames, checklist	1 per student
FEEDBACK CARDS	cut into four · voting slips at the bottom	1 per student
CERTIFICATES	cut in half · fill the names in at lunch	4 per group
ANSWER KEYS	reading key and grammar key from the pack	teacher only

NOTES FOR THE TEACHER

IF YOU ARE RUNNING LATE

Cut “The greatness test” to five minutes and set task 2 of the grammar sheet as homework. Do not cut Rehearsal 1 – an unrehearsed ten minutes always becomes fourteen.



SESSION 1 · 11.00 – 11.45 · REVISION AND PAST SIMPLE

11.00	5'	WARMER · THREE FACTS	PAIRS
Books closed. In pairs, write down everything you remember about Elizabeth I in three minutes. Then count: the pair with the most <i>correct</i> facts wins.			
11.05	10'	READING RECALL	IND → CLASS
Sheet VI, page 2, task 1 (True / False / Not Given). Students may re-read page 1 first for two minutes, then close it. Check as a class; ask “which paragraph?” every time.			
11.15	13'	LISTENING · THE QUEEN WHO SAID NO	IND → PAIRS
Listening sheet. Task 1 (words) before you read anything aloud. Read the script once at normal speed – students do task 2 only. Read it a second time, slightly slower, pausing at the marks – students do tasks 3 and 4. Check in pairs, then as a class.			
11.28	12'	PAST SIMPLE	IND → PAIRS
Sheet XII. Task 1 (choose a, b or c) against the clock – six minutes, then swap sheets and mark. Task 2 (verbs in brackets): items 1–5 now, 6–10 as homework if time is short. Board the three shapes: was/were · -ed / irregular · did + infinitive .			
11.40	5'	SET THE BIG QUESTION	CLASS
Write on the board: WHAT MAKES A GREAT PERSON? Each student writes one word that must be in the answer. Collect the words on the board – do not discuss them yet. Tell them these words come back after the break.			

SESSION 2 · 12.00 – 13.35 · PREPARING THE PRESENTATION

12.00	12'	MY CRITERIA	IND → TEAM
Great Person sheet, task 1. Alone: tick your five. In the team: agree on three and write them in the box. The team must be able to say why each one is in and why one popular word was left out.			
12.12	18'	EVIDENCE HUNT	TEAM
Great Person sheet, task 2. Go back to Sheet VI and the listening. For each criterion find something Elizabeth <i>did</i> , with a year. No year, no evidence.			
12.30	10'	THE GREATNESS TEST	TEAM
Great Person sheet, task 3. Four things Elizabeth really did – two that look great and two that do not. Rate each one against your own criteria. This is where the presentation gets its honesty, and it is what separates a report from an argument.			
12.40	10'	ROLES AND THE CLOCK	TEAM
Presentation kit, page 1. Fill in the timing plan with real names. Six roles, ten minutes. Everybody speaks. Nobody speaks for more than two and a half minutes.			
12.50	25'	WRITE YOUR PART	IND
Presentation kit, page 2. Each student drafts their own part using the sentence frames. Teacher circulates and corrects Past Simple forms only – leave everything else.			
13.15	15'	REHEARSAL I	TEAM
Full run with a stopwatch. One student holds the checklist and ticks. Stop at ten minutes even if they are not finished – that is the point of the exercise.			
13.30	5'	FIX LIST	TEAM
Three things to change, written at the bottom of the kit. Not more than three.			



SESSION 3 · 14.05 – 15.40 · PLENARY, PRESENTATIONS, AWARDS

14.05	5'	SET UP	CLASS
Hand out the feedback cards, one per student, already cut. Explain the three awards and that everyone votes at the end.			
14.10	70'	PRESENTATIONS	PLENARY
About ten minutes per team plus two minutes of questions. The audience fills in one feedback card per team. Teacher keeps time visibly and does not interrupt.			
15.20	10'	VOTING AND COUNTING	CLASS
Students tear off the three slips and post them. Two students count while the teacher gives whole-class feedback on the English – three things that worked, three to fix.			
15.30	10'	AWARDS AND CLOSE	CLASS
Read out the certificates. One or two “most active” per group, the debate winners and the winners of the game. Close by reading three of the morning’s words from the board and asking whether the day changed anybody’s answer.			

NOTES FOR THE TEACHER

THE DIFFICULT SENTENCE IN THE AUDIO

The script says that Elizabeth’s father had her mother killed. That is what happened: Anne Boleyn was beheaded on 19 May 1536, when Elizabeth was two years and eight months old. Say it plainly, do not dwell on it, and move on to what the child did next – she studied.

THE TILBURY QUOTATION

“I know I have the body but of a weak, feeble woman; but I have the heart and stomach of a king” – Tilbury, 9 August 1588. Most historians accept the speech as genuine; a minority doubt the text. If a student asks whether she really said it, the honest answer is “probably, and that is a good question”.

TWO FACTS THE ORIGINAL CLASS TEXT HAD WRONG

Elizabeth died on

24

March 1603, not the 14th, and she was queen for

44

years, not 45 (17 November 1558 to 24 March 1603). Both are corrected on every sheet in this pack.

THE AWARDS, IN ORDER

Read the certificate out, say the one thing the person did that earned it, then hand it over. One or two “most active” per group as agreed, then the debate winners, then the winners of the game. Keep it to ninety seconds a name – the applause is the reward, the paper is the souvenir.

CLOSING THE INTENSIVE

Go back to the board and read out three of the words the group wrote at 11.40. Ask one question and stop: *after today, would you keep your word, or change it?* Take three answers. Do not sum up for them.